TGPSC Group I | Paper III, Unit I, Topic 5 — Social Policies and Programmes

Integrated editable student edition — 30 October 2026. NOT INDEPENDENTLY ACADEMICALLY APPROVED.

This master retains the substantive 18-section analytical supplement, 30 original four-option practice MCQs and six structured original mains answers **once each**. Earlier legacy detailed notes and practice sets remain preserved in separate source files for provenance, but are excluded here to avoid duplicated questions and unreviewed repetition. Original **complete-notes.pdf** is unchanged. All MCQs and mains are original practice, **not authenticated TGPSC PYQs**.

Current law: India Code Act 36 of 2025 and Ministry of Rural Development notifications confirm that the VB–G RAM G Act came into force on 1 July 2026, replacing MGNREGA 2005, with 125 days of wage employment per eligible rural household per financial year. This is a legal entitlement, not proof of actual Telangana implementation. The source register at the end of Part A records provenance and outstanding checks.

Part A — New substantive supplement

Paper III — Unit I — Topic 5 | Social Policies and Programmes in India and Telangana

Original substantive recovery supplement | 25 October 2026 | Editorial status: draft, not independently academically approved

This supplement accompanies the existing Topic 5 draft. It does not replace or certify the previously published PDF. Questions below are **original practice questions**, not authenticated TGPSC previous-year questions. Source identifiers refer to the dated evidence register at the end, not to pages of textbooks or official examination papers.

Syllabus map and learning objectives

The notified topic covers policies for women, children, older people and persons with disabilities; Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, Backward Classes and minorities; environmental and population policy; education and health policy; poverty alleviation; and welfare programmes in India and Telangana. The syllabus is not a request to memorise scheme names. A high-scoring answer must distinguish constitutional principle, statutory entitlement, executive scheme, implementing institution, financing, eligibility, delivery failures and measurable results. The same programme may serve several syllabus heads: an Anganwadi is simultaneously a nutrition, early childhood, women's work and health-convergence institution, but its multiple roles must not be conflated.

Core analytical question: When does a public promise become an enforceable right, a budgeted service, and an actually received benefit? Use a six-stage chain: constitutional objective → law/policy → budget and rules → frontline service → beneficiary experience → independent outcome audit. At each stage ask what can fail, who is excluded and which authority can remedy the failure.

1. Constitutional architecture: formal equality, substantive equality and social protection

Articles 14 and 15 establish equality and non-discrimination, while Article 15(3) allows special provisions for women and children and Article 15(4) addresses specified disadvantaged groups. Article 16 concerns equality of opportunity in public employment; Article 17 abolishes untouchability. Articles 21 and 21A connect dignity and education to enforceable rights, but the legal route for a particular benefit depends on the relevant statute. Directive Principles such as Articles 38, 39, 41, 42, 45, 46 and 47 guide public policy; their non-justiciable character should not be mistaken for absence of constitutional significance. Article 46 expressly urges promotion of educational and economic interests of weaker sections, particularly Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes.

Three forms of intervention require different evaluations. **Protective regulation** prohibits harm, such as discrimination or child exploitation; success depends on reporting, inspection and remedy. **Redistribution** supplies pensions, scholarships or food; success depends on adequacy, timeliness and inclusion. **Capability-building** supplies education, healthcare, accessible infrastructure or land security; success depends on long-run opportunities and control over decisions. Reservation is a representation instrument, not a substitute for adequate schooling or enforcement of anti-atrocity law. A benefit financed from a budget is not necessarily a legal entitlement; an entitlement may still be denied in practice through administrative error. Distinguish legal enforceability from operational reach.

A useful Telangana illustration is a rural woman with a disability seeking a scholarship for her child, healthcare and a pension. She encounters overlapping gender, disability, location and income barriers. Separate departments may individually report high enrolment while her household remains excluded because the bank record, disability certificate and residence details do not match. Convergence must therefore be assessed at the **household's completed service journey**, not by counting interdepartmental meetings. The rights-based position emphasises non-discrimination and appeal; the fiscal-administrative position emphasises targeting and leakage control. A defensible synthesis uses clear eligibility, minimal documentation, assisted access, independent grievance review and audited public expenditure.

2. The difference between a policy, a statute, a scheme and a government order

A policy sets direction; legislation creates legal duties and powers; a scheme translates objectives into eligible beneficiaries, benefits and procedures; an administrative order modifies implementation within lawful authority. A minister's speech is evidence of intent, not proof of implementation. This distinction matters especially in Telangana, where welfare programme names and promised amounts can change across governments. Historical district scheme pages may retain launch-period figures long after the operational rules have changed. For example, district-hosted Aasara descriptions establish that the pension programme targeted older people, widows and certain occupational groups, but their 2014-era amounts should **not** be copied as current 2026 entitlements [S12]. Similarly, a state initiatives webpage may list a proposed benefit alongside a delivered benefit. Verify sanction orders, start dates, payment records and grievance rules before claiming full rollout [S11].

Use a source hierarchy: (1) enacted law and gazette, (2) current signed rules and orders, (3) official department programme manual, (4) audited expenditure and outcome data, (5) independent research and contemporaneous reporting. When two official pages disagree, date both and say the operational status is unresolved. An examination answer can be decisive about the **type** of policy while remaining appropriately cautious about an unverified current amount. Avoid treating budget allocation as spending, applications as beneficiaries, or approved benefits as successfully delivered services.

3. Women: protection, care infrastructure, mobility and control over resources

The evolution from 'welfare for women' to 'women-led development' is meaningful only if women's agency improves. Mission Shakti has **Sambal** for safety and security, including One Stop Centres and women's helplines, and **Samarthya** for empowerment, including Shakti Sadans, working-women hostels, maternity support and childcare-related components [S01]. A One Stop Centre is not a substitute for a functioning police investigation, legal aid, trauma-informed healthcare or safe long-term housing. The Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act, 2005 offers civil protection and residence-related remedies; the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace Act, 2013 creates workplace complaint mechanisms. They are not interchangeable. The maternity-benefit framework and childcare provision also matter for women in informal work who may not enjoy employer-provided leave.

Consider a self-help-group borrower in a Telangana mandal. A bank loan may increase household enterprise capital without increasing her decision-making power if the husband controls proceeds or if market access is missing. Better evaluation combines account ownership with independent control of earnings, enterprise survival, paid-work hours, safety of travel and time spent on unpaid care. Free public transport can reduce mobility cost where routes and eligibility fit; it cannot resolve unsafe last-mile walking or lack of childcare. State-specific schemes should be dated and their eligibility verified rather than presumed universal [S11].

Contrasting approaches: A cash-first view values immediate choice and poverty relief; a public-services view stresses creches, healthcare, safety and accessible transport. These are complements rather than a binary choice. The administrative solution is a district referral pathway from One Stop Centre to medical care, protection officer, legal services authority and livelihood support, with consent, confidentiality and follow-up. Outcome measures should include timely protective orders, safe case closure, reduced repeat violence and women's ability to exercise choice—not publicity events.

4. Children: the distinction between nutrition, learning and protection

The child-policy lifecycle begins with maternal nutrition, antenatal care and birth registration; continues through immunisation, early stimulation, Anganwadi nutrition, foundational learning and adolescence; and requires specialised protection when children face abuse, abandonment or exploitation. Mission Saksham Anganwadi and Poshan 2.0 integrates supplementary nutrition, early childhood care, nutrition education and convergence with public-health services. Its six services include supplementary nutrition, preschool education, nutrition and health education, immunisation, health check-up and referral; some services are delivered through health-system partnerships [S02]. Mission Vatsalya, by contrast, finances child-care and protection structures associated with the Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015 [S03]. Neither programme is a substitute for the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, 2012 or child labour enforcement.

Stunting is low height-for-age, usually reflecting chronic deprivation; wasting is low weight-for-height, associated with acute malnutrition; anaemia is a different clinical indicator. A single 'malnutrition rate' conceals distinct pathways. Poshan Tracker, rolled out in 2021, can support monitoring but digitally entered growth measures require measurement quality, privacy and error correction [S04]. The 2023 national community malnutrition-management protocol emphasises identification, treatment, referral and follow-up [S05]. For a seasonal migrant family in Hyderabad's construction sector, the problem may be transfer of Anganwadi or school access between locations, not merely lack of awareness. A district-level convergence register should protect the child's continuity without imposing repeated documentation demands.

Under the National Food Security Act, 2013, Sections 4 and 5 establish specified nutritional supports for pregnant and lactating women and children; PM POSHAN provides cooked school meals under its applicable rules [S06, S07]. Food availability does not guarantee dietary diversity or learning. School attendance, age-appropriate nutrition, protection case resolution and foundational literacy must be separately monitored. Treat every child as a rights holder, not merely a dependent on an adult's beneficiary card.

How the six-service system works in practice. The Ministry of Women and Child Development lists supplementary nutrition, preschool education, nutrition-and-health education, immunisation, health check-up and

referral as six Anganwadi-linked services; immunisation, health check-up and referral depend on coordination with the health system rather than being independent clinical functions of an Anganwadi worker [S20]. A district officer should therefore trace a child through **screening → recorded measurement → clinical referral where indicated → treatment → return visit**, instead of counting a referral slip as successful treatment. The 2023 community malnutrition protocol gives a basis for distinguishing community follow-up from cases needing medical-facility care [S05].

Worked administrative example (illustrative, not Telangana statistics). Suppose 120 children are due for monthly growth monitoring, 105 are measured, 12 are flagged for clinical assessment and only 7 complete the referral. Measurement coverage is 105/120 = 87.5%, whereas referral completion is 7/12 ≈ 58.3%. Reporting 87.5% as “nutrition success” would conflate a process indicator with a health outcome. Investigate missed migrant households, inaccurate weighing, transport barriers and whether the seven children received appropriate care. The corrective response is a confidential follow-up register, assisted transfers between centres and a verified referral closure process—not public disclosure of identifiable children's health records. [S20][S05]

5. Older persons: pensions are necessary but insufficient

Population ageing changes the welfare problem from one-time relief to predictable income, healthcare and long-term care. Article 41 refers to public assistance in old age within the State's economic capacity. The Maintenance and Welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Act, 2007 establishes a statutory maintenance and welfare framework. Social pensions such as those under the National Social Assistance Programme and Telangana's Aasara/other notified pension systems have different funding sources, eligibility and administrative processes. An old district webpage describing Aasara's initial design is historical evidence, not proof of the present pension amount [S12].

An older widow in a village may have an approved pension but still lack usable income if payment is delayed or the nearest banking point is far away. A mobile-payment or biometric system can reduce diversion yet exclude people with worn fingerprints, limited mobility or inconsistent identity records. A rights-respecting service must provide alternative authentication, doorstep assistance where authorised and a documented appeals process. Urban Hyderabad raises another set of risks: isolation, insecure rental housing, elder abuse and expensive chronic-disease treatment. Social protection requires links between primary care, assistive devices, legal aid, community outreach and caregivers.

Evaluation should measure months of uninterrupted pension receipt, inflation-adjusted adequacy, travel time to cash-out, untreated chronic conditions, reported abuse and successful resolution of grievances. Institutional residential care is appropriate for some individuals but should not automatically displace community-based living. A fiscal critique of universal pensions highlights budget pressure; a rights critique of narrow targeting highlights wrongful exclusion. Transparent criteria, portable records and social audits improve both legitimacy and value for money.

6. Persons with disabilities: from medical certification to accessibility and accommodation

The Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 adopts a rights-based framework with equality, non-discrimination, inclusive education, reasonable accommodation and accessibility obligations [S08]. Sections 32 and 34 address reservation in higher education and government employment for persons with benchmark disabilities in the legally specified settings. The commonly cited figures—at least 5% higher-education seats and not less than 4% government employment vacancies—must not be presented as a blanket rule for all private institutions or jobs. Certification and UDID infrastructure help eligibility administration, but the certificate is an entry point, not the final outcome.

In a Telangana degree college, a student with hearing impairment may receive a scholarship yet be unable to participate without captioning, sign-language interpretation, accessible announcements and fair examinations. A wheelchair-accessible ramp that ends at an inaccessible toilet is not meaningful accessibility. A visually impaired job candidate needs compatible online forms, examination arrangements and workplace adaptation. Disability

policy therefore combines social protection with anti-discrimination and design of ordinary institutions. It also requires listening to disabled persons' organisations when defining priorities.

A district accessibility audit should test the **whole journey**—public transport, entry, information, service counter, payment and complaint—not count ramps alone. Useful outcomes include school progression, employment retention, participation in local government and time taken to obtain reasonable accommodation. The medical model focuses on diagnosis and rehabilitation; the social model locates disadvantage in environments and exclusion. Effective policy integrates necessary healthcare with removal of social barriers.

Legal meaning of accommodation. The Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities explains that reasonable accommodation under the 2016 Act means necessary, appropriate adjustments in a particular case, without disproportionate or undue burden, to enable equal enjoyment of rights [S21]. It is distinct from a generic ramp-building target: a deaf applicant may require captioned instructions, a blind applicant a screen-reader-compatible form, and a person with limited mobility an accessible examination venue. An institution should record the barrier, proposed adjustment, decision-maker, completion date and accessible appeal route. A refusal needs a reasoned, case-specific assessment; “we treat everyone identically” is not a sufficient inclusion test.

Whole-journey evaluation. For a hypothetical district college, audit admission notification, online form, transport, entrance, classroom, library, washroom, examination, grievance channel and placement office. Count not only physical modifications but requests received, requests resolved before the relevant deadline, abandoned applications and students completing a term. Example: if 20 students request accommodation, 18 receive it but 6 only after the examination, timely accommodation is 12/20 = 60%, not 18/20 = 90%. This denominator matters because a late service may be functionally useless. The official DEPwD FAQ explicitly includes education, work, transport, communications and access to justice in public facilities and services [S21].

7. Scheduled Castes: representation, protection, education and economic security

SC policy combines constitutionally supported affirmative action, prohibition of untouchability, protection against targeted offences and programmes to expand capabilities. The Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 have different offences and enforcement pathways. Scholarships, hostels, residential education, entrepreneurship support and land-related assistance respond to resource inequality. None makes anti-discrimination enforcement redundant. A high school may enrol SC children while reproducing segregation through classroom treatment or access to facilities; this is why completion, learning and safe school climate matter alongside enrolment.

Telangana's Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes Special Development Fund Act, 2017 (Act 18 of 2017) creates a statutory framework for specified earmarking and use of resources. The State's official SCSDF publication describes the law and the 13 September 2017 rules order [S10]. Earmarking is a **budget-design rule**, not proof that the allocated money reached intended groups or reduced inequalities. Examine allocations, releases, actual expenditure, beneficiary targeting and completed assets. The possibility of a programme being 'SC-targeted' in a budget document does not settle whether its benefits are additional, accessible or equitably distributed within the category.

Debates over sub-classification, creamy-layer arguments and intra-group disparities require attention to the governing judicial and statutory position at the relevant date. Do not confuse a political proposal with enacted rules. Strong Telangana examples are residential-school completion, safe hostel accommodation, land-title security, skill-to-job conversion and effective response to caste-based violence. An answer should make both a social-justice argument and an accountable public-finance argument.

8. Scheduled Tribes: territorial rights, services and self-government

ST welfare differs from a generic poverty programme because land, forests, habitat, language and community governance can be central to collective rights. Article 244 and the Fifth Schedule establish special constitutional arrangements for Scheduled Areas. PESA, 1996 concerns local self-government in applicable Scheduled Areas; the Forest Rights Act, 2006 provides processes to recognise individual and community forest rights [S09]. They are related but not interchangeable. A school scholarship cannot compensate for unlawful dispossession of customary resources; conversely, a land-rights certificate alone cannot ensure maternal care or functioning schools.

A Koya hamlet near a forest boundary may face overlapping disputes about cultivation, access to minor forest produce, school distance and health transport. Administrative coordination must respect the Gram Sabha's lawful role, identify which authority decides a particular rights claim and provide an appeal route. PM-JANMAN is targeted to Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups, not all Scheduled Tribes. Avoid generalising from one community to another: Gond, Koya, Kolam and Chenchu histories and settlement patterns are not identical. Language-sensitive teaching and mobile health services can matter as much as infrastructure counts.

A developmentalist position may prioritise roads, hospitals and market access; a self-determination position prioritises consent, customary tenure and ecological security. These need not conflict if projects are designed through lawful consultation and rights recognition before irreversible land-use changes. Measure recognised community rights, functioning Gram Sabha decisions, forest-resource income retained locally, school attendance in mother-tongue settings and health-service continuity. A claim about 'tribal development expenditure' should always be tested against whether the affected community gained durable control and choice.

Sequence of forest-rights recognition. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs explains that the Forest Rights Act recognises individual cultivation and habitation rights alongside community rights such as grazing, fishing, access to water bodies and community forest-resource management [S22]. Its published rules assign the Gram Sabha an initiating role: receiving and hearing claims, preparing claimant lists, passing resolutions and forwarding them to the Sub-Divisional Level Committee [S22]. A claim lodged is therefore not equivalent to a title granted; likewise, an individual title is not proof that a community forest-resource claim was decided. An exam answer should keep **claim filed → Gram Sabha process → committee scrutiny → decision and record correction** analytically separate, and should not invent the outcome of a particular Telangana village's claim.

Worked governance scenario. A hypothetical hamlet has 60 individual applications and one community claim over a shared water-and-forest area. A dashboard that reports 50 individual titles as “83% of forest rights completed” would ignore the community claim, the land area actually recognised, any pending appeals and the implications for collective resource management. A better district review separates individual and community categories, reasons for rejection, time to decision, gender of title-holders where recorded, and whether the recognised rights can actually be exercised. Ecological conservation is not automatically opposed to recognition: the Act also assigns forest and biodiversity protection responsibilities to rights holders and the Gram Sabha [S22].

9. Backward Classes and minorities: classification, identity and multidimensional deprivation

Backward Class programmes address social and educational disadvantage through reservation where legally applicable, hostels, scholarships, occupational support and financial assistance. Central OBC and Telangana BC lists are not necessarily identical; a person's status for a state scheme does not automatically establish eligibility for a Union recruitment or scholarship programme. Classification decisions, surveys and reservation notifications are distinct legal acts. Intra-group inequalities also matter: support that disproportionately reaches better-connected applicants may fail the most disadvantaged families.

Minority policy draws on constitutional equality and Articles 29–30 concerning cultural and educational rights, together with institution-specific scholarship and credit programmes. Article 29 is not confined exclusively to minorities, while Article 30 specifically addresses religious and linguistic minorities' educational institutions. Hyderabad's Telugu, Urdu and Dakhni linguistic contexts illustrate why language access affects service delivery. An Urdu-speaking parent may have difficulty navigating an English-only digital scholarship portal even when legally

eligible. Identity-sensitive services should avoid stereotyping communities or assuming that religious affiliation alone explains poverty.

A sound evaluation uses disaggregated evidence on school progression, professional education, credit terms, residential location and discrimination. Debate over group-targeted versus income-targeted aid is not solved by declaring one approach universally superior. Social discrimination can persist among households with similar income; equally, income distress may cross categories. Layered targeting—social disadvantage plus household need, with transparent rules—can address both concerns while preserving constitutional requirements.

10. Education: from enrolment to learning, inclusion and transitions

Article 21A and the Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009 anchor free compulsory elementary education for ages six to fourteen. National Education Policy 2020 proposes reforms in foundational learning, inclusion, curriculum and governance; a policy document is not itself proof that each reform has been implemented in every school [S13]. Samagra Shiksha supports school education from pre-primary to Class XII, including inclusive education, teacher development and foundational literacy/numeracy [S14]. PM POSHAN supplies a school meal and can support attendance and nutrition, but its effectiveness depends on food safety, adequate menus, regular cooking and accountability [S07].

A Telangana government school can show improved enrolment after a transport initiative but still suffer poor reading outcomes because teachers are overburdened or instruction is not adapted to first-generation learners. School buildings, toilets, digital devices and scholarship approvals are **inputs**; attendance, grade-level learning, safe transitions and completion are **outcomes**. The right indicator depends on the policy claim. Digital learning can widen access where devices and teachers are available but exacerbate inequality where connectivity, home language or disability accommodation is neglected.

Mains answers should examine the full transition from Anganwadi to primary school, upper primary, secondary, higher education and work. Girls may face safety or care-work barriers; tribal children may need mother-tongue support; disabled students may need assistive formats. These are not separate 'special cases' to be added at the end; they should shape ordinary school design. Social audits, independent learning assessments and community participation are essential checks on expenditure-based success narratives.

Institutional delivery, not only policy aspiration. The official Samagra Shiksha description treats school education as a continuum from pre-school to Class XII, with inclusion, teacher preparation and learning outcomes as explicit objectives [S23]. Its inclusive-education component identifies Braille and large-print material, assistive devices, specialised support and teacher adaptation as possible interventions [S23]. Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalayas address residential-school access for specified disadvantaged girls, but enrolment in a hostel cannot by itself demonstrate safety, learning or successful transition to Class XII. A district review should disaggregate attendance, age-appropriate reading, mathematics, retention and transition, with careful privacy protections.

Currentness caveat for school meals. The Ministry of Education's PM POSHAN page describes the approved 2021–22 to 2025–26 scheme and its cooked-meal design; a separate official 2026–27 Programme Approval Board page states that a further five-year cycle was due for appraisal and records a temporary extension only up to 30 September 2026 or earlier approval [S24]. Those pages alone do **not** establish the programme's exact administrative approval position on 30 October 2026. Do not infer either permanent discontinuation or a newly approved five-year extension. Obtain the subsequent competent-authority approval before making that claim. For a Telangana school, inspect dated meal registers, ingredient supply, kitchen safety and actual meals served, then separately test attendance and learning; neither a budget release nor an approved menu proves that children received safe food. [S24]

11. Health: public health, primary care and financial protection

National Health Policy 2017 prioritises preventive and promotive care, health-system strengthening and access to services [S15]. Public health interventions—immunisation, sanitation, vector control, nutrition, screening and disease surveillance—create benefits that an insurance card cannot purchase alone. Hospital insurance addresses eligible treatment costs at specified facilities; it does not automatically ensure primary-care access, essential medicines, transport or follow-up. The National Health Mission and comprehensive primary-care framework should be evaluated through staffing, continuity, referral and service quality.

Telangana's official state initiatives portal describes Cheyutha-linked Rajiv Arogyasri financial coverage, but the portal's stated ceiling and projected family counts must be distinguished from claims paid, service utilisation and outcomes [S11]. For an elderly patient with diabetes in a remote mandal, the critical policy may be continuous medicines, diagnostics and transport rather than a high-cost inpatient package. For a Hyderabad slum household, sewage, pollution and occupational exposure may dominate illness risk. Health equity demands attention to social determinants, not only hospitals.

Compare three indicators: **coverage** (who is eligible and enrolled), **access** (who can actually obtain timely care) and **effectiveness** (who experiences improved health without catastrophic expenditure). A scheme may perform well on the first and poorly on the other two. District administrators should publish facility functionality, referral completion, out-of-pocket spending and quality outcomes with privacy safeguards. The ethical tension is between rapid expansion of financial protection and investment in universal primary-care capacity; an effective strategy balances both.

12. Population policy: demographic transition without coercion

National Population Policy 2000 links reproductive health, maternal and child survival, education and informed voluntary choices [S16]. Fertility rate, birth rate, population growth and age structure are different concepts. Even after fertility falls to replacement level, population may continue to grow for some time because of momentum from a large cohort of younger adults. A demographic dividend arises only when health, education and employment permit productive participation; it is not an automatic result of a favourable age ratio.

Policy should be judged by unmet need for contraception, safe reproductive care, maternal mortality, girls' education and informed consent—not by coercive targets. The rights-based position rejects punitive restrictions that may disproportionately affect poor and marginalised women. A public-finance position notes the need to plan schools, housing and pensions against population change. Both can be addressed through voluntary services, transparent demographic projections and investments in human capability.

Telangana's rural-to-Hyderabad migration makes local service demand differ from official residence-based counts. Municipal schools and clinics must plan for temporary and circular migrants, while ageing rural districts need accessible chronic care. A district with falling fertility may still need more classrooms in growing urban settlements. An answer that equates 'population control' with development misses migration, age structure and gender equality.

13. Environment: regulation, ecological services and distributive justice

The Environment (Protection) Act, 1986, Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974 and Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1981 provide distinct legal tools; Articles 48A and 51A(g) add constitutional environmental commitments. Environmental impact assessment, consents, emission monitoring, waste management and restoration are not synonyms. Environmental clearance is a conditional administrative decision, not evidence that a project causes no harm. Public participation, baseline measurements, cumulative impacts and post-clearance compliance are central.

Musi pollution illustrates a chain problem: sewage collection, treatment capacity, industrial effluent control, stormwater and encroached floodplains require different interventions. A beautified riverfront without pollution-source reduction does not improve water quality. Coal-mining districts face livelihood, air, land and rehabilitation questions. Groundwater-stressed agricultural regions require demand management and crop choices

as well as supply-side engineering. Compare 'polluter pays' with the reality that enforcement costs may fall on communities least able to litigate.

Environmental policy should identify who benefits from a project, who bears costs and how compensation, consultation and ecological recovery are verified. Measure actual pollutant loads, functioning treatment capacity, seasonal water quality, health exposure and compliance action—not tree-planting photographs. Where tribal forest rights are implicated, environmental decisions must be reconciled with the relevant statutory rights process rather than treated as a purely technical clearance.

14. Poverty alleviation: cash, work, food and public services

Poverty is multidimensional: low income interacts with malnutrition, unsafe housing, poor sanitation, education gaps, disability and insecure work. Historically, MGNREGA 2005 provided a demand-driven legal guarantee of 100 days of unskilled wage employment per eligible rural household. From 1 July 2026, the VB–G RAM G Act, 2025 replaced that law and provides 125 days per eligible rural household whose adult members volunteer for unskilled manual work; the entitlement is household-based, not 125 days per adult [S17][S18][S19]. The National Food Security Act, 2013 establishes food and nutrition entitlements in specified categories [S06]. Pensions and scholarships provide different protections. One household may need several instruments simultaneously, but that does not justify duplicate or inaccessible paperwork.

Consider a landless labour household in a drought-prone Telangana mandal. Work demand under the current VB–G RAM G framework may reduce distress migration, while public food support stabilises consumption and an Anganwadi supports a young child's nutrition. None alone guarantees escape from poverty if wages are delayed, productive assets are poorly maintained or schooling is interrupted. Public works should be evaluated for timely employment and useful water/soil assets; food security for regular access and nutritional quality; livelihood programmes for sustained earnings. Do not infer poverty reduction merely from money disbursed.

A universalist approach reduces exclusion but costs more; narrow targeting conserves funds but can exclude eligible people through outdated lists. The best design often combines broad foundational services, transparent means-tested supplements, accessible appeals and periodic list correction. District dashboards should distinguish demand for work, work actually provided, delayed payments, eligible households excluded, food access and longer-term income changes. Causal attribution requires caution: improved household outcomes may also reflect rainfall, market prices or migration.

15. Telangana-specific social protection: changing governments, durable entitlements

Telangana's welfare landscape includes social pensions, residential education, SC/ST special development budgeting, women's mobility support, health financial protection, housing and livelihood interventions. These instruments have different histories and administrative authorities. Aasara was introduced as a social-security pension for specified vulnerable groups; old district scheme pages are useful for history but not for present rates [S12]. The state initiatives portal describes programmes such as Cheyutha, Mahalakshmi and Gruha Jyothi, but each component's legal notification, eligibility and actual rollout must be checked separately [S11]. The SC/ST Special Development Fund Act of 2017 offers a useful statutory example of targeted budget design [S10].

A district-level policy matrix should contain programme name, date of operative order, department, eligible group, benefit, fiscal source, last verified expenditure, service quality and appeal route. Without this matrix, political debate becomes a competition of slogans. A promise of a particular monthly transfer should not be copied into exam notes as an implemented entitlement unless the signed order and payment evidence support it. Likewise, a scheme may be operational but unevenly delivered; acknowledging this does not deny its legal or political importance.

Contrast three Telangana geographies: urban Hyderabad requires migrant-inclusive service delivery and affordable health access; dryland districts require livelihood security and irrigation-sensitive planning; Scheduled Areas require attention to forest/land rights and culturally appropriate education. A uniform district target can conceal

structural differences. Programme evaluation should report coverage **and** exclusion by sex, disability, caste/tribe, geography and age, while respecting data privacy and avoiding stigmatising labels.

16. Budgeting, federalism, social audit and grievance redress

Welfare delivery is a multi-level public-finance process. Parliament and State legislatures authorise spending; Union ministries and State departments set scheme rules; district officers supervise frontline services; Gram Sabhas, municipalities, statutory commissions, courts and audit institutions provide distinct accountability mechanisms. Centrally sponsored schemes may have prescribed cost-sharing ratios, but these vary by scheme and period. A state top-up or state scheme cannot automatically be described as a Union entitlement. Public accounts distinguish budget estimates, revised estimates, actual expenditure and outstanding liabilities.

An administrative audit must track the path from sanction to payment to actual service. If a scholarship is approved but not credited before fees are due, the programme has failed a timing requirement even if eventual spending appears in the accounts. If a hospital is empanelled but routinely refuses eligible patients, a cardholder's coverage is nominal. If a public building has a ramp but inaccessible information, disability access is incomplete. Social audit adds beneficiary testimony, public disclosure and community verification; it is not the same as an internal utilisation certificate.

A robust grievance system has published eligibility rules, assisted application, a written acknowledgement, time-bound decision, independent appeal and transparent aggregate outcomes. Digital dashboards should expose error rates and corrected exclusions without disclosing sensitive personal data. For mains answers, connect fiscal prudence to measurable public value rather than equating low expenditure with efficiency. Rights, budgets and service quality must be jointly examined.

17. Cross-cutting case studies for Telangana administrators

Case A — Anganwadi continuity for a migrant family

A construction-worker family moves from a rural district to Hyderabad. Their child is absent from the old Anganwadi register and not yet added to the new one. The district should first ensure nutrition and immunisation referral, then correct records with assisted transfer and minimal repeated documentation. Coordination is required among the Anganwadi worker, health staff and urban local body. Measure days without nutrition service and successful follow-up, not the number of forms collected. The legal policy distinction is between service eligibility and administrative registration.

Case B — Disability certificate but inaccessible college

A student with a benchmark disability receives a certificate and scholarship but cannot use classrooms or online examination software. The college must assess statutory accessibility and reasonable accommodation duties, make a time-bound adaptation plan and provide an accessible grievance route. The success measure is participation and course completion, not certificates issued. Budgeting must cover assistive formats and staff training, not only building work.

Case C — SC/ST development fund and incomplete hostel

A district reports an allocated residential-education hostel under the 2017 special development fund framework. The building is incomplete and students travel long distances. Audit must compare allocation, release, procurement milestones, functional completion, occupancy and learning outcomes. A completed expenditure statement does not prove educational benefit. Community feedback should test safety, food quality and student attendance.

Case D — Pension exclusion through biometric mismatch

An elderly widow's pension payment fails repeatedly at a banking point. The district must verify her continuing eligibility, provide lawful alternative authentication or assisted payment, correct records and document arrears. Audit indicators include missed months, time to restoration and successful appeal. Fraud control is legitimate, but a control that systematically excludes eligible people defeats the policy objective.

Case E — Forest rights and school access in a tribal hamlet

A Scheduled Area hamlet requests school transport while its community forest-rights claim remains unresolved. The administration should not make schooling conditional on surrendering a rights claim. Distinct authorities must handle education service delivery and the statutory FRA process, with Gram Sabha participation as legally required. Indicators include attendance, mother-tongue support, claim decisions and access to livelihood resources.

Case F — Health insurance without primary-care continuity

A diabetic patient in a remote mandal has a health-coverage card but no reliable local testing or medicines. The district should map primary-care service gaps, referrals, medicine supply and travel burden alongside the inpatient insurance package. Success is reduced complications and out-of-pocket expenditure, not the nominal coverage ceiling. This case illustrates why health insurance and public health systems are complements.

18. Synthesis, comparisons and quick revision

Rights versus discretion: An enforceable statutory entitlement has a different remedy from a discretionary scheme; verify the legal instrument. **Universalism versus targeting:** Broad provision can reduce exclusion, while narrowly targeted benefits can direct scarce funds but generate documentation and list errors. **Cash versus services:** Cash increases choice but cannot by itself create functioning schools, clinics or accessible transport. **Protection versus empowerment:** Preventing violence and discrimination must be combined with durable opportunities. **Digital efficiency versus inclusion:** Faster processing is valuable only when errors can be corrected without humiliating beneficiaries. **Budget versus outcome:** Allocation, expenditure, coverage, quality and social impact are separate measurements.

For a 200–250-word mains answer use: **Background / constitutional basis → institutional mechanisms → Telangana illustration → implementation limitations and competing views → actionable way forward and conclusion.** Name at least one law, one delivery institution and one measurable outcome. Avoid claiming that a recent scheme is fully implemented solely because an official webpage lists it. Distinguish original practice questions from authenticated commission PYQs.

Three original analytical diagrams

- **Constitutional-to-beneficiary chain** — explains how an entitlement can fail between law, budgeting, delivery and experienced outcome. See **diagrams/01_entitlement_chain.svg**.
- **Policy instrument comparison** — distinguishes protective regulation, redistribution and capability-building, with a different success test for each. See **diagrams/02_policy_matrix.svg**.
- **Telangana district convergence** — maps the service continuity challenge faced by a migrant child. See **diagrams/03_district_convergence.svg**.

Dated primary-source and evidence register (original sources checked 25 October; S20–S24 directly checked 30 October 2026)

ID	Institution / dated instrument	Verified evidence and limitation
S01	Ministry of Women and Child Development, Mission Shakti programme portal, accessed 25 Oct 2026	Sambal/Samarthya components and programme design; not independent outcome evaluation. https://www.wcd.gov.in/women/mission-shakti
S02	MWCD, Saksham Anganwadi & Poshan 2.0, guidelines dated 1 Aug 2022, portal accessed 25 Oct 2026	Six Anganwadi services and eligible groups; programme description not a district performance audit. https://wcd.gov.in/offerings/nutrition-mission-saksham-anganwadi-and-poshan-2-0-mission-saksham-anganwadi-poshan-2-0
S03	MWCD, Mission Vatsalya official programme portal, accessed 25 Oct 2026	Link to Juvenile Justice Act and child-protection services; state outcomes not audited. https://wcd.gov.in/offerings/mission-vatsalya-scheme
S04	MWCD, Poshan Tracker programme page, rollout 2021, accessed 25 Oct 2026	ICT monitoring description; measurement validity and district error rates not independently tested. https://wcd.gov.in/offerings/poshan-tracker
S05	MWCD/MoHFW, Protocol for Management of Malnutrition in Children, launched 10 Oct 2023	Referral and community management protocol; full district implementation records unavailable. https://www.wcd.gov.in/offerings/schemes-services-mission-poshan-2-0-portals-protocol-for-management-of-malnutrition-in-children
S06	India Code, National Food Security Act, 2013, original central legislation	Statutory nutrition provisions in sections 4–5; current implementation depends on applicable rules. https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/2113/1/201320.pdf
S07	Ministry of Education, PM POSHAN programme portal, 2021–22 to 2025–26 approved scheme	Scheme purpose and school-meal delivery; local food safety records not inspected. https://pmposhan.education.gov.in/aboutus.html
S08	India Code, Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016, enacted 27 Dec 2016	Sections 3, 16–17, 20, 32, 34 and 40–46; state implementation orders require separate verification. https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/13684
S09	Ministry of Tribal Affairs, Forest Rights Act, 2006 and official PESA/Act collection	Individual/community rights and Gram Sabha responsibilities; Telangana claim-level registers unavailable. https://tribal.nic.in/FRA.aspx
S10	Government of Telangana, SC/ST Special Development Fund Act 2017 described in official 2026 state budget publication	Act 18/2017 and rules G.O.Ms.No.53 dated 13 Sep 2017; budget earmark is not audited outcomes. https://www.telangana.gov.in/wp-content/uploads/2026/03/Scheduled-Castes-Special-Develop-Fund-SCSDF.pdf
S11	Government of Telangana, Government Initiatives portal, accessed 25 Oct 2026	Descriptions of Cheyutha, Mahalakshmi and Gruha Jyothi; **individual rollout and payment claims not independently certified**. https://www.telangana.gov.in/government-initiatives/

ID	Institution / dated instrument	Verified evidence and limitation
S12	Government of Telangana, Hyderabad district Aasara pension page, dated 1 Oct 2018–30 Jun 2021	Historical programme purpose and launch-era amounts; **not evidence of current 2026 pension rates**. https://hyderabad.telangana.gov.in/scheme/aasara-pensions/
S13	Ministry of Education, National Education Policy 2020, official PDF	Policy recommendations, not proof of state-by-state implementation. https://education.gov.in/sites/upload_files/mhrd/files/NEP_Final_English_0.pdf
S14	Department of School Education and Literacy, Samagra Shiksha implementation guidelines	School education scope and inclusion objectives; district outcomes not audited. https://dsel.education.gov.in/sites/default/files/update/ss_implementation.pdf
S15	Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, National Health Policy 2017	Public-health and primary-care policy framework; local facility-level results not retrieved. https://cdsco.mohfw.gov.in/opencms/opencms/en/consumer/National-Health-Policy/
S16	Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, National Population Policy 2000, official reprint	Reproductive health and voluntary choice; no unsupported district fertility estimates used. https://mohfw.gov.in/sites/default/files/26953755641410949469%20%281%29.pdf
S17	Ministry of Rural Development, MGNREGA historical portal (legacy scheme evidence, NOT current legal authority)	Former 100-day guarantee under the repealed 2005 law; do not cite as the operative 2026 entitlement. https://nrega.nic.in/
S18	India Code, VB–G RAM G Act, 2025, Act 36 of 2025, enacted 20 Dec 2025	Primary enacted text: 125 days per eligible rural household in each financial year; not 125 days per adult. https://www.indiacode.nic.in/indiacode/handle/123456789/22478?view_type=browse
S19	Ministry of Rural Development, PIB 11 May 2026 PRID 2259703 and 1 July 2026 PRID 2279995	Statutory commencement and MGNREGA repeal effective 1 July 2026; does not establish actual Telangana delivery. https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2259703&lang=1&reg=1 ; https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleaseIframePage.aspx?PRID=2279995&lang=2&reg=48

| S20 | Ministry of Women and Child Development, Mission Saksham Anganwadi and Poshan 2.0 programme page, directly checked 30 Oct 2026 | Six service types, division of responsibilities with health system; **not** a Telangana referral-completion audit. https://wcd.gov.in/offerings/nutrition-mission-saksham-anganwadi-and-poshan-2-0-mission-saksham-anganwadi-poshan-2-0 |

| S21 | Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities, official accessibility FAQ, directly checked 30 Oct 2026 | Statutory definition of reasonable accommodation and public facilities; individual college outcomes not inspected. https://depwd.gov.in/en/faqs-4/ |

| S22 | Ministry of Tribal Affairs, FRA official explanation and published rules, directly checked 30 Oct 2026 | Individual/community rights and Gram Sabha claim-processing role; no Telangana claim register consulted. https://tribal.nic.in/FRA.aspx ; https://tribal.nic.in/FRA/data/FRARulesBook.pdf |

| S23 | Ministry of Education, Samagra Shiksha official programme and inclusive education pages, directly checked 30 Oct 2026 | Pre-school–Class XII scope and inclusion interventions; no verified Telangana learning-outcome dataset. https://samagra.education.gov.in/about.html ; https://samagra.education.gov.in/inclusive.html |

| S24 | Ministry of Education, PM POSHAN official programme and 2026–27 Programme Approval Board pages, directly checked 30 Oct 2026 | Published approval through 2025–26 and temporary extension information through 30 Sep 2026; **does not establish 30 Oct 2026 renewal status**. https://pmposhan.education.gov.in/aboutus.html ; https://pmposhan.education.gov.in/PAB_PM_POSHAN.html |

Current-law evidence: [S18] India Code, Act 36 of 2025 (125 household-days); [S19] Ministry of Rural Development PIB 11 May and 1 July 2026 (commencement/repeal). See source register for official URLs. Current Telangana implementing orders and district delivery were not independently audited.

Outstanding audit: Direct signed Telangana government orders for every current scheme amount, district-wise pension disbursement records, independent scheme impact evaluations, beneficiary appeals datasets, complete original commission question papers and a genuinely independent academic review are not available in this run. The topic must remain **NOT ACADEMICALLY APPROVED**.

Part B — Newly authored original MCQs

Thirty original explained practice MCQs

Original educational questions, not authenticated TGPSC PYQs.

MCQ 1

Question: Which provision directly prohibits untouchability?

A. Article 17
B. Article 41
C. Article 48A
D. Article 30

Correct answer: A. Article 17
Explanation: Article 17 abolishes untouchability; the other provisions concern assistance, environment and minority education.

MCQ 2

Question: What best distinguishes a scheme from an enacted statute?

A. Every scheme is enforceable like a statute
B. A scheme operationalises benefits through administrative rules, while a statute creates legal duties and powers
C. A scheme requires no public funding
D. Statutes never concern welfare

Correct answer: B. A scheme operationalises benefits through administrative rules, while a statute creates legal duties and powers
Explanation: An executive scheme and an Act have different legal status; enforceability depends on the precise instrument.

MCQ 3

Question: Which pair comprises the two sub-schemes of Mission Shakti, as described by the Ministry of Women and Child Development?

A. Sambal and Mission Vatsalya
B. Mission Vatsalya and Mission Poshan 2.0
C. Samarthya and Mission Poshan 2.0
D. Sambal and Samarthya

Correct answer: D. Sambal and Samarthya
Explanation: The Ministry names Sambal (safety/security) and Samarthya (empowerment) as Mission Shakti's two sub-schemes. Mission Vatsalya is the separate child-protection programme, while Mission Poshan 2.0 concerns nutrition and early-childhood services. All four names denote real programmes or sub-schemes, but only option D pairs the two within Mission Shakti. [MWCD Mission Shakti, Mission Vatsalya and Mission Poshan 2.0 programme pages; checked 27 October 2026.]

MCQ 4

Question: Which is the most defensible indicator of women’s economic empowerment?

A. Number of loan applications
B. Number of publicity events

C. Independent control over earnings and durable work
D. Number of scheme posters

Correct answer: C. Independent control over earnings and durable work
Explanation: Control over resources and sustainable participation indicate agency beyond enrolment.

MCQ 5

Question: Which programme finances child care and protection services connected with the Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act?

A. Samagra Shiksha
B. Mission Saksham Anganwadi and Poshan 2.0
C. PM POSHAN
D. Mission Vatsalya

Correct answer: D. Mission Vatsalya
Explanation: Mission Vatsalya supports child-protection institutions and services under the Juvenile Justice framework. Poshan 2.0 primarily addresses nutrition and early childhood services; PM POSHAN supports school meals; Samagra Shiksha is an integrated school-education programme. Each alternative is a genuine social-sector programme, but the statutory child-protection connection identifies D. [MWCD Mission Vatsalya/Poshan 2.0; Ministry of Education PM POSHAN/Samagra Shiksha, checked 27 October 2026.]

MCQ 6

Question: A child has low height-for-age. Which indicator is involved?

A. Wasting
B. Stunting
C. Underemployment
D. Maternal mortality

Correct answer: B. Stunting
Explanation: Stunting is measured using height-for-age, distinct from wasting based on weight-for-height.

MCQ 7

Question: Which is the correct pairing of a nutrition law and entitlement?

A. NFSA 2013 — specified maternal and child nutrition supports
B. RPwD Act — school meals
C. PESA — universal maternity cash transfer
D. Air Act — Anganwadi meals

Correct answer: A. NFSA 2013 — specified maternal and child nutrition supports
Explanation: NFSA Sections 4 and 5 contain nutrition entitlements; programme implementation follows applicable rules.

MCQ 8

Question: Poshan Tracker was rolled out in which year, according to MWCD?

A. 2000
B. 2006
C. 2021
D. 2026

Correct answer: C. 2021
Explanation: The official MWCD programme page dates the digital tracker rollout to 2021.

MCQ 9

Question: Which Act provides the principal central rights framework for disability?

A. National Food Security Act 2013
B. Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act 2016
C. PESA 1996
D. MGNREGA 2005

Correct answer: B. Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act 2016
Explanation: RPwD Act 2016 addresses non-discrimination, inclusion and accessibility.

MCQ 10

Question: Under section 34 of the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016, the minimum reservation in government-establishment vacancies for persons with benchmark disabilities is generally:

A. 3%
B. 5%
C. 1%
D. 4%

Correct answer: D. 4%
Explanation: Section 34 prescribes not less than four per cent of the relevant government-establishment vacancies, with statutory conditions and distribution among categories. Five per cent is the separate higher-education seat reservation in section 32; one per cent is used for specified component categories within section 34, not the overall minimum. Three per cent is not the section 34 total. [India Code, RPwD Act 2016, sections 32–34; checked 27 October 2026.]

MCQ 11

Question: Which is a whole-journey accessibility indicator?

A. Ramps constructed only
B. Certificates issued only
C. Usable transport, building, information, service and grievance access
D. Number of policy slogans

Correct answer: C. Usable transport, building, information, service and grievance access
Explanation: An accessible entrance without usable service counters or information does not ensure participation.

MCQ 12

Question: Which law specifically addresses specified caste- and tribe-based atrocities?

A. SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act 1989
B. Environment Protection Act 1986
C. National Population Policy 2000
D. POSH Act 2013

Correct answer: A. SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act 1989
Explanation: The SC/ST PoA Act provides a distinct protective framework beyond general welfare schemes.

MCQ 13

Question: Which instrument enacted Telangana's SC/ST Special Development Fund framework, rather than merely issuing its implementing rules?

A. Telangana State Act 18 of 2018
B. Telangana G.O.Ms.No.53 dated 13 September 2017
C. Union Act 18 of 2017
D. Telangana State Act 18 of 2017

Correct answer: D. Telangana State Act 18 of 2017
Explanation: The Telangana State Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes Special Development Fund (Planning, Allocation and Utilization of Financial Resources) Act, 2017 is State Act 18/2017. G.O.Ms.No.53 of 13 September 2017 concerns rules under that Act, not its enactment. The Union and 2018 alternatives misidentify the legislature or year. [Telangana Government Scheduled Castes Special Development Fund budget statement, 2023–24; checked 27 October 2026.]

MCQ 14

Question: Which measure is the strongest evidence of an effective SC student hostel programme?

A. Budget announcement
B. Land acquisition only
C. Safe operational hostel with attendance and educational progression
D. Number of press releases

Correct answer: C. Safe operational hostel with attendance and educational progression
Explanation: Actual functionality and student outcomes matter more than a nominal allocation.

MCQ 15

Question: Which is primarily a self-government framework for Scheduled Areas?

A. PESA 1996
B. PM POSHAN
C. Mission Vatsalya
D. National Food Security Act

Correct answer: A. PESA 1996
Explanation: PESA concerns panchayat governance in applicable Scheduled Areas, distinct from FRA rights recognition.

MCQ 16

Question: Which statement about FRA 2006 is most accurate?

A. It only provides cash pensions
B. It recognises qualifying individual and community forest rights
C. It is the same law as PESA
D. It applies to every urban property

Correct answer: B. It recognises qualifying individual and community forest rights
Explanation: FRA provides procedures for recognition of forest-related rights and community resource governance.

MCQ 17

Question: Which group is PM-JANMAN specifically designed to address?

A. All residents of Hyderabad
B. All persons above 60
C. Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups
D. All Union government employees

Correct answer: C. Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups
Explanation: PM-JANMAN is a targeted initiative for PVTGs; it is not a universal ST programme.

MCQ 18

Question: Central OBC and state BC lists should be treated as:

A. Always identical
B. Potentially different with scheme-specific eligibility
C. Automatically replaced by census
D. Irrelevant for reservation

Correct answer: B. Potentially different with scheme-specific eligibility
Explanation: Central and state lists can differ; check the legal framework for the specific programme.

MCQ 19

Question: Which constitutional article specifically protects minority rights to establish and administer educational institutions?

A. Article 30
B. Article 17
C. Article 48A
D. Article 41

Correct answer: A. Article 30
Explanation: Article 30(1) concerns religious and linguistic minorities' educational institutions.

MCQ 20

Question: Article 21A of the Constitution of India directly guarantees free and compulsory education for which age group?

A. 3–6 years
B. 14–18 years
C. 6–18 years
D. 6–14 years

Correct answer: D. 6–14 years
Explanation: Article 21A covers children aged six to fourteen. Early-childhood care below six is addressed separately in Article 45; section 31 of the RPwD Act gives a distinct six-to-eighteen-year entitlement to children with benchmark disabilities. Neither expands Article 21A itself to all children under eighteen. [Ministry of Education, Article 21A/86th Amendment guidance; India Code RPwD Act section 31; checked 27 October 2026.]

MCQ 21

Question: Samagra Shiksha is best described as:

A. Only a university scholarship
B. An integrated school-education programme spanning pre-primary to Class XII
C. Only an insurance scheme
D. Only an urban pension

Correct answer: B. An integrated school-education programme spanning pre-primary to Class XII
Explanation: Its scope covers school education and quality/inclusion objectives.

MCQ 22

Question: Which is an educational outcome rather than an input?

A. Computers purchased
B. Buildings sanctioned
C. Grade-level reading attainment
D. Teacher recruitment notices

Correct answer: C. Grade-level reading attainment
Explanation: Learning attainment reflects capability; equipment and announcements are inputs.

MCQ 23

Question: What is a key limitation of hospital insurance alone?

A. It replaces all prevention
B. It guarantees continuous primary-care medicines
C. It may not resolve primary-care, transport or follow-up gaps
D. It eliminates every health inequality

Correct answer: C. It may not resolve primary-care, transport or follow-up gaps
Explanation: Financial protection for eligible hospital services does not ensure comprehensive public-health access.

MCQ 24

Question: Which policy was issued in 2017?

A. National Health Policy
B. National Population Policy
C. NEP
D. PESA

Correct answer: A. National Health Policy
Explanation: National Health Policy was issued in 2017; the others have different dates.

MCQ 25

Question: Which statement about replacement fertility is correct?

A. It guarantees immediate zero population growth
B. Population momentum may continue despite replacement fertility
C. It measures infant mortality
D. It is identical to the crude birth rate

Correct answer: B. Population momentum may continue despite replacement fertility
Explanation: Large younger cohorts can sustain population growth after fertility reaches replacement level.

MCQ 26

Question: Which legislation provides a general environmental protection framework enacted in 1986?

A. Environment (Protection) Act
B. Air Act

C. Water Act
D. Forest Rights Act

Correct answer: A. Environment (Protection) Act
Explanation: The Environment (Protection) Act is 1986; Water and Air Acts are 1974 and 1981.

MCQ 27

Question: What is the most credible indicator of river-cleanup effectiveness?

A. Length of beautified embankment
B. Number of slogans
C. Reduced pollutant loads and verified water-quality improvement
D. Number of ribbon-cuttings

Correct answer: C. Reduced pollutant loads and verified water-quality improvement
Explanation: Source reduction and measured water quality are more probative than cosmetic works.

MCQ 28

Question: Under the VB–G RAM G Act, 2025, effective from 1 July 2026, what is the statutory wage-employment guarantee for an eligible rural household whose adult members volunteer for unskilled manual work?

A. 100 days per rural household under the former MGNREGA 2005 framework
B. 125 days per eligible rural household in a financial year
C. 125 days separately for every adult member of the household
D. An automatic cash grant without demand for wage employment

Correct answer: B. 125 days per eligible rural household in a financial year
Explanation: The new law guarantees 125 household-days, not individual adult entitlements. A describes the former 100-day MGNREGA framework, repealed from 1 July 2026. C wrongly changes the entitlement unit from household to each adult. D confuses demand-based wage employment with an unconditional cash transfer. Official evidence: India Code Act 36 of 2025 and Ministry of Rural Development, PIB 11 May and 1 July 2026 [S18][S19].

MCQ 29

Question: What should not be inferred from an old Aasara district webpage?

A. Historical purpose of the scheme
B. Launch-era eligibility groups
C. The exact current 2026 pension amount
D. That social pensions address vulnerability

Correct answer: C. The exact current 2026 pension amount
Explanation: Old pages document historical design; current amounts require current operative orders.

MCQ 30

Question: Which best distinguishes expenditure from outcomes?

A. Both always mean the same
B. A released scholarship is automatically a graduation
C. Actual spending must be compared with beneficiary receipt and lasting results
D. Only allocations should be audited

Correct answer: C. Actual spending must be compared with beneficiary receipt and lasting results
Explanation: Budget release, payment, service quality and social outcomes are distinct links in the delivery chain.

Part C — Newly authored structured mains answers

Six original structured mains model answers

Original practice responses; not authenticated TGPSC PYQs.

Question 1: Assess the strengths and limitations of a rights-based approach to social welfare in India, with Telangana illustrations.

Answer word count (including headings): 223

Introduction. A rights-based approach treats welfare recipients as citizens entitled to fair treatment rather than passive beneficiaries. Its strength is to link constitutional equality with enforceable duties, transparent rules and remedies for exclusion. Yet legal recognition alone does not guarantee accessible services.

Constitutional and legal foundation. Articles 14, 15, 17 and 21A support equality and education, while Directive Principles guide social protection. The National Food Security Act creates specified nutritional entitlements; the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act mandates non-discrimination and accessibility. Administrative schemes may remain discretionary unless backed by binding provisions.

Telangana application. Consider an elderly widow whose pension is blocked by biometric failure, or a student with a disability whose college has no accessible examination system. Both illustrate the gap between formal eligibility and actual receipt. The 2017 Telangana SC/ST Special Development Fund framework adds a statutory budgeting dimension, but allocation is not evidence of completed benefit.

Limitations and counterview. Fiscal capacity, weak frontline staffing, overlapping departmental responsibilities and outdated records constrain delivery. Narrow targeting can reduce expenditure yet create wrongful exclusion. Universal provision may improve access but requires sustainable financing and service capacity.

Way forward and conclusion. Publish operative eligibility rules, provide assisted applications and alternative authentication, strengthen independent appeals and audit outcomes rather than publicity. A rights-based welfare state succeeds when law, budget and everyday administrative experience converge.

Question 2: Explain how women’s safety, economic empowerment and care services must be integrated in Telangana.

Answer word count (including headings): 214

Background. Women's welfare is multidimensional: freedom from violence, control over income, mobility and time for paid work are interdependent. A cash benefit may relieve immediate need without removing structural barriers to participation.

Legal and programme mechanisms. Mission Shakti separates Sambal safety measures, including One Stop Centres and helplines, from Samarthya empowerment components. The Domestic Violence Act, 2005 and workplace sexual-harassment legislation provide distinct remedies. Childcare and maternity support reduce the unpaid-care burden that otherwise restricts employment.

Telangana illustration. A self-help-group member in a rural mandal may receive credit but lack reliable transport, market access or control over proceeds. Mobility initiatives can reduce travel cost, while a functioning creche enables regular work. Neither automatically ensures safety on the final journey or financial independence. A district should link protection officers, healthcare, legal aid, livelihoods and accessible transport.

Critical evaluation. Loan counts, helpline calls and programme registrations are output indicators, not proof of empowerment. Women may fear reporting abuse; digital access and documentation may exclude migrants and women with disabilities. A cash-first perspective stresses choice, while a services-first perspective emphasises public infrastructure. Both contributions are necessary.

Conclusion. Measure safe case resolution, income controlled by women, employment retention, care hours and effective grievance response. Integrating protection, care and opportunity makes policy more than a collection of announcements.

Question 3: Distinguish child nutrition, education and protection policies and propose a district convergence strategy.

Answer word count (including headings): 218

Introduction. Children need adequate nutrition, learning and protection throughout the lifecycle, but each need involves different laws, professionals and indicators. Treating all child welfare as a single scheme hides critical delivery gaps.

Nutrition. Mission Poshan 2.0 supports Anganwadi nutrition and early childhood services. The National Food Security Act provides specified maternal and child nutrition entitlements. Stunting, wasting and anaemia should be tracked separately because they reflect different conditions and interventions.

Education. Article 21A and the Right to Education Act cover free compulsory elementary education for ages six to fourteen. Samagra Shiksha and PM POSHAN support inclusive learning and school meals. Attendance alone cannot establish foundational literacy or educational quality.

Protection. Mission Vatsalya supports the Juvenile Justice child-care system, while POCSO and child-labour law address distinct risks. Child Welfare Committees and district protection officials require trained referral pathways.

Telangana application. When a construction-worker family migrates to Hyderabad, the child may lose continuity of Anganwadi, school and immunisation records. A district convergence protocol should enable assisted transfer without withholding immediate nutrition or schooling. Frontline workers must coordinate with health facilities and urban local bodies.

Way forward. Track uninterrupted service days, growth measurements, learning progression and safe protection-case closure, with privacy safeguards. Budget convergence is useful only when the child experiences continuity. Child-centred planning combines entitlements, quality and accountable referral.

Question 4: Evaluate Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe welfare through representation, resource rights and development funds.

Answer word count (including headings): 220

Introduction. SC and ST welfare requires more than poverty transfers because exclusion may involve discrimination, unequal representation, insecure land tenure and lack of control over common resources. The appropriate instruments therefore differ across contexts.

SC framework. Article 17 prohibits untouchability. The Protection of Civil Rights Act and SC/ST Prevention of Atrocities Act address specified harms. Reservation, scholarships, residential education and livelihood assistance aim to widen opportunity. Their effectiveness depends on quality and enforcement, not merely sanctioned seats.

ST framework. The Fifth Schedule, PESA and Forest Rights Act address territorial governance and qualifying individual or community forest rights. PESA concerns Scheduled Area self-government; FRA concerns recognition of forest rights. These cannot be replaced by an income grant. Culturally appropriate schooling and health access remain necessary.

Telangana application. The SC/ST Special Development Fund Act, 2017 provides a targeted budgeting framework. A hostel allocation is not a functioning hostel; a forest-rights application is not an approved title. Administrators must trace sanctioned funds, actual completion, Gram Sabha procedures and service outcomes.

Critical perspectives. Redistributive policy addresses immediate deprivation, while empowerment requires secure rights and institutional voice. Poor targeting and unequal reach within broad categories can reproduce disadvantage.

Conclusion. Combine anti-discrimination enforcement, transparent development budgeting, meaningful local participation and measurable educational and livelihood outcomes. Report group-specific evidence without treating all communities as identical.

Question 5: Why must disability and old-age policies go beyond pensions and certificates?

Answer word count (including headings): 216

Background. Pensions and certificates are important administrative instruments, but inclusion depends on whether people can move, communicate, obtain care and exercise choices with dignity. Ageing and disability overlap without being the same condition.

Disability rights. The Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 requires equality, accessibility and reasonable accommodation. Specified reservation provisions support representation, while accessible teaching, transport, public information and workplaces enable actual participation. A certificate alone cannot remove barriers.

Older persons. Article 41 guides assistance in old age, and the Maintenance and Welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Act, 2007 provides a maintenance framework. Social pensions help income security, but chronic care, protection from abuse, affordable transport and community support remain essential.

Telangana cases. A student with a disability may receive a scholarship but face inaccessible examinations. An elderly widow may lose pension payments because biometric verification fails. Both need assisted service, lawful alternatives, written decisions and appeals. Urban isolation and rural travel distance create different policy demands.

Limitations. Counting ramps, certificates or approved pensioners overstates success when toilets, service counters, medicines or payments remain inaccessible. Strict fraud controls may inadvertently exclude eligible residents.

Way forward. Audit the complete service journey, restore interrupted payments, invest in community healthcare and consult affected groups. Measure participation, employment retention, continuous income and resolved grievances, not only paperwork.

Question 6: Critically examine poverty-alleviation policy as a combination of employment, food, health and education.

Answer word count (including headings): 222

Introduction. Poverty is not only inadequate income. It also includes hunger, poor health, insecure employment, interrupted schooling and weak access to public services. Consequently, no single transfer or programme can reliably eliminate deprivation.

Employment and food. The VB–G RAM G Act, 2025 provides a demand-driven statutory guarantee of 125 days of unskilled wage employment per eligible rural household from 1 July 2026; MGNREGA 2005 was the preceding 100-day law. The National Food Security Act establishes specified food and nutrition entitlements. Timely work, wage payment, food access and nutritional quality must be measured separately.

Human capabilities. Anganwadi nutrition, PM POSHAN, school education and primary healthcare reduce longer-term deprivation. Insurance for hospital treatment can limit eligible expenses but does not substitute for preventive care, regular medicines or safe drinking water.

Telangana application. A landless household in a drought-prone mandal may need rural work, reliable food support, childcare and school continuity simultaneously. In Hyderabad, a migrant household may face housing, documentation and service-portability barriers. A scheme's budget expenditure does not establish improved household capability.

Debate. Universal services can limit wrongful exclusion but require funding and capacity. Narrow targeting conserves resources yet may depend on inaccurate lists. Effective design combines accessible foundational services, transparent targeted support and a working appeal mechanism.

Way forward and conclusion. Track work demanded and supplied, delayed wages, nutrition, learning, out-of-pocket health costs and durable earnings. Coordinate programmes around households while respecting privacy. Poverty alleviation succeeds when immediate protection enables long-term autonomy.